

The Coca-Cola Company

CAGNY Feedback

Our biggest takeaway in watching the KO presentation (beyond the obvious momentum in the business) was the notion of scale and how scale confers benefits across all aspects of the business (from sales to productivity, and, at the intersection of the two, marketing).

Presenters: James Quincey (CEO), John Murphy (CFO)

What's Incremental

We think KO's presentation will prove to be fairly distinct this week, with messaging conveying considerable momentum currently behind the portfolio as well as compelling long-term growth prospects... We believe the latter stands out at a time when many other Staples categories face existential questions about structural headwinds to demand (particularly in the US); meanwhile, KO reiterated the long runway left to pursue, especially to drive commercial beverage development in developing and emerging markets (e.g. commercial beverages still only at 32% of total consumption, albeit up from 27% a decade ago).

...but for us, the biggest takeaway in listening to CEO James Quincey and CFO John Murphy was the common through line of scale and the way in which this is driving success across the organization – with interwoven benefits evident across sales, marketing and productivity efforts.

- **Sales:** We've written on a variety of occasions the way in which the revamped KO System is driving sustainable topline growth near the higher end of KO's long-term +4-6% algorithm. We were once again struck by the strength of topline momentum evident in today's messaging, including what felt like increasing attention paid on the collection of \$1B+ brands in KO's portfolio. The company took care to acknowledge half of its 30 \$1B brands were created organically, 3 were acquired and 12 were grown into \$1B status after being acquired. And this robust portfolio of \$1B brands enables KO to do more with fewer brands, with that unique scale serving as an important driver in the company's ~+9% sales CAGR over the last five years. KO has continued to gain NARTD value share (+100 bps to 29% in 2024), while the other large players have lost an aggregate ~100 bps since last year (to 40%) and the long tail of small players' share is ~stable at 31%.

And importantly, we think the breadth of KO's portfolio was also on full display. There has been plenty of momentum behind the Coca-Cola brand family over the last several years, but today's presentation left us with a better appreciation of other areas that are working well or enjoy robust growth opportunities ahead. One such example would be other sparkling flavors (Sprite and Fanta), which have seen much more targeted efforts since the global category

KO	OVERWEIGHT
U.S. CHPC & Beverages	NEUTRAL
Price Target	USD 73.00
Price (14-Feb-25)	USD 68.87
Potential Upside/Downside	+6.0%
Source: Bloomberg, Barclays Research	

U.S. CHPC & Beverages

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Completed: 18-Feb-25, 18:22 GMT Released: 18-Feb-25, 18:26 GMT Restricted - External

leads were developed and combined would represent the fourth largest NARTD company. Meanwhile, the stills portfolio has nearly doubled over the last decade and accounts for the majority of KO's \$1B brands.

- **Marketing:** Recall, Studio X was set up in 2023 so was still in the early innings of being introduced to the Street as of last year's CAGNY. This year, we appreciated the range of tangible examples and data to backup the merits of this new model. As a reminder, KO focused its activities via a single relationship with WPP - structured as 200 agencies united under the WPP umbrella, referred to as "Studio X." Within this, there are eight different marketing capabilities (e.g. production, adaption, ad ops) all working together directly as a team in each of Studio X's nine physical hubs (one per operating unit) versus under more typical models where these work streams could all be managed independently, adding time, complexity and potentially conflict to the process.

The improved scale inherent in the new model has yielded 1.4x faster speed and a respective +10% and +20% improvement in efficacy and efficiency vs. a service agreement benchmark. While the concept of lifting and shifting is certainly not new, putting this goal into practice is made much simpler with Studio X, and the System can execute at an increasingly granular level. What's more, KO is managing recruitment at an increasingly segmented way, managing even the conversion of "intenders" and "neutrals" by brand, channel, package, etc. rather than taking broader (and less effective) measures.

- **Productivity:** Generally speaking, productivity savings are perhaps the most obvious avenue for benefits of scale to materialize in the P&L – still, we're intrigued by the variety of ways KO is leveraging the System's scale in this regard beyond the benefits that stem from Studio X. For example, the System now manages third-party logistics from a total network-perspective (vs. the historical approach to optimize locally), which translates both to savings but also better supply certainty. The System's scale also puts it in a unique position in terms of procurement and hedging practices by entering into very long-term agreements with suppliers, warehouses, etc.

What to do with the stock

KO's outlook feels credible and largely within KO's control to execute on regardless of the dynamic macro environment - and this is precisely the kind of defense and visibility that had made this one of our most favored names within the Staples universe this year. We continue to like KO given 1) our confidence in KO's OSG that screens highly attractive across the group and 2) the relative insulation that KO's global portfolio and footprint enjoys to various headline risks that are weighing on the rest of Staples (e.g. tariffs, GLP1s and broader health & wellness trends in the US).

As always, please feel free to call with any questions or comments.

Best,

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The Coca-Cola Company (KO, 14-Feb-2025, USD 68.87), Overweight/Neutral, A/CD/CE/D/E/J/K/L/M/N

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U.S. CHPC & Beverages

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Constellation Brands (STZ)	Coty Inc. (COTY)	Edgewell Personal Care Company (EPC)
Energizer Holdings, Inc (ENR)	International Flavors & Fragrances (IFF)	Kenvue Inc. (KVUE)
Keurig Dr Pepper (KDP)	Kimberly-Clark Corp. (KMB)	Molson Coors Beverage Company (TAP)

Newell Brands Inc. (NWL)	ODDITY Tech Ltd. (ODD)	Olaplex Holdings, Inc. (OLPX)
PepsiCo Inc. (PEP)	Procter & Gamble (PG)	Reynolds Consumer Products (REYN)
The Coca-Cola Company (KO)	The Estée Lauder Companies (EL)	

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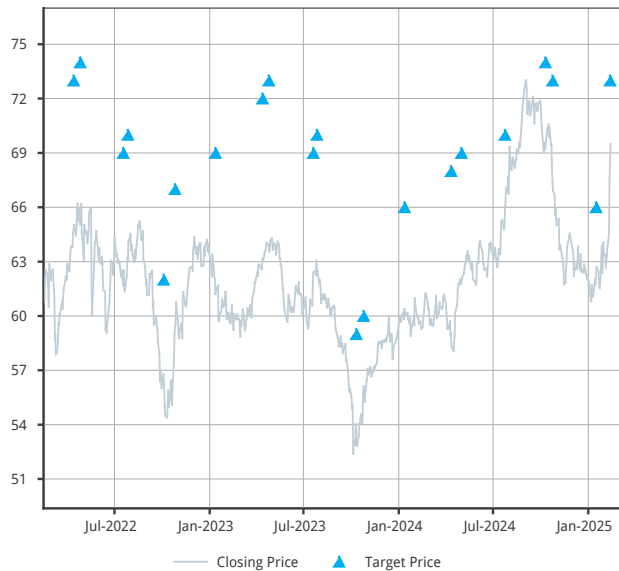
Stock Rating: **OVERWEIGHT**

Industry View: **NEUTRAL**

Closing Price: **USD 68.87** (14-Feb-2025)

Rating and Price Target Chart - USD (as of 14-Feb-2025)

Currency=USD



Source: IDC, Barclays Research

[Link to Barclays Live for interactive charting](#)

Publication Date	Closing Price*	Rating	Adjusted Price Target
12-Feb-2025	67.60		73.00
16-Jan-2025	61.77		66.00
24-Oct-2024	68.01		73.00
10-Oct-2024	69.57		74.00
24-Jul-2024	64.96		70.00
01-May-2024	61.77		69.00
11-Apr-2024	59.72		68.00
12-Jan-2024	59.81		66.00
25-Oct-2023	55.64		60.00
11-Oct-2023	54.03		59.00
27-Jul-2023	63.05		70.00
20-Jul-2023	61.64		69.00
25-Apr-2023	63.95		73.00
13-Apr-2023	62.69		72.00
12-Jan-2023	61.21		69.00
26-Oct-2022	58.95		67.00
04-Oct-2022	56.78		62.00
27-Jul-2022	63.21		70.00
18-Jul-2022	61.65		69.00
26-Apr-2022	65.94		74.00
13-Apr-2022	64.73		73.00

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Source: Bloomberg, Barclays Research

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